

Integer & Absolute Value Battle

Unit 9: Treasure Map Navigator · Lesson 9-2 · EduWonderLab

UNIT 9 · LESSON 9-2 · TEACHER NOTES

Standard 6.NS.7

FORMAT Card battle / distance from zero	TIME 25–30 min
GROUPING Pairs	TOPIC Integers and Absolute Value
STANDARD 6.NS.7	PREP LEVEL Light — print integer cards and number-line mats

Learning goal *I can find absolute value and compare distance from zero.*

Teacher setup

- Print one card set and number-line mat per pair.
- Players draw integers, place them on the line, and find absolute value.
- Greatest distance from zero wins, unless a challenge card reverses the rule.

Materials

Integer cards, Number line mats, Absolute value boxes, Pencil.

Differentiation & language support

- Number line keeps distance from zero visible (SPED).
- Sentence stem: “ $|\underline{\quad}| = \underline{\quad}$ because the distance from zero is $\underline{\quad}$.”
- ESOL: define absolute value as “distance from zero.”

Key vocabulary (English / Español):

Term	Español	What it means
integer	entero	a positive or negative whole number
absolute value	valor absoluto	distance from zero, always positive

Quick teacher check: *Watch for students who think $|-5| = -5$.*

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Class:

What you need

How to play

1. Draw a card and place the integer on the number line.
2. Find its absolute value (distance from zero).
3. Compare distances with your partner.
4. The greater distance wins the round.

Battle Cards

1. $|-5|$

2. $|8|$

3. $|-12|$

4. $|0\rangle$

5. Which is farther from 0: -7 or 4 ?

6. Compare $|-3|$ and $|2|$.

7. $|-10|$

8. Order by absolute value: $-6, 3, -1$.

Record your work (absolute value + compare):

Explain your thinking

Sentence frame: | ___ | = ___ because the distance from zero is ___.

★ **Challenge:** Find two different integers that have the same absolute value. (e.g., -9 and 9)

ANSWER KEY

Teacher copy — please do not distribute to students.

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Answers

1. $ -5 $ Answer: 5	2. $ 8 $ Answer: 8
3. $ -12 $ Answer: 12	4. $ 0 $ Answer: 0
5. Which is farther from 0: -7 or 4 ? Answer: -7 (distance $7 > 4$)	6. Compare $ -3 $ and $ 2 $. Answer: $ -3 = 3 > 2 = 2$
7. $ -10 $ Answer: 10	8. Order by absolute value: $-6, 3, -1$. Answer: -1 (1), 3 (3), -6 (6)

Teaching notes & look-fors

- Absolute value is always 0 or positive.
- Card 5: -7 is farther from zero than 4 , even though 4 is the larger number.